

industries, agriculture and service sectors. Said Xavier Jayakumar, a minister from the Malaysian State of Selangor, who led the Malaysian delegation: "At this rate of investment, one won't be able to recognise Gujarat two decades from now." Indeed, the last three Vibrant Gujarat investment summits generated combined project proposals worth over Rs 8 lakh crore, out of which around 60 per cent has been realised in projects under implementation. The proposals in the latest summit contain employment potential of 25 lakh people.

Telecom czar Sunil Mittal was unusually outspoken in paying tributes to Modi. "We have seen CEOs running good companies but Modi is that successful CEO who runs an entire state. We need him in Delhi," he said. Not a single sector remained untouched by the investment spree. The ports sector saw proposals worth Rs 87,000 crore while the power sector attracted Rs 3,27,000 crore, Rs 28,700 crore went to the agri sector, Rs 40,000 crore to engineering, Rs 43,000 crore each to IT, oil and gas, Rs 55 crore to the tourism sector and Rs 1,20,000 crore to urban development. The most prominent feature of the event was a major stride in the solar energy generation sector that Gujarat has taken by coming out with a solar power generation policy which could spur a revolution in power generation. As Modi said: "Our solar initiative will go a long way in tilting the scales in favour of renewable energy."

No wonder then that the summit saw investment worth Rs 61,000 crore to generate 3,300 MW in the solar energy generation sector, which is a record in the history of India in



this field. The event saw India's first ever Ymax broadband-enabled exhibition. At the summit, Air Deccan founder Captain Gopinath promised to turn Ahmedabad into a gateway of India by transforming it into a cargo and logistics supply hub. In the ports sector too, Gujarat leads the way with 42 ports which are now seeking investments worth Rs 87,000 crore. Gujarat is also the only state to have its own 1,400-km-long gas grid which

is being extended up to 2,200 km.

Modi emerged the star of the show. The chief minister also showed that his sartorial sense is equally well-tuned for the occasion. Of late, he has abandoned his short-sleeved kurtas in favour of snappy suits and casual chic. For the opening function, he wore a two-button suit with collar open and a long scarf dangling from his neck. At the valedictory function, he was dressed in a dark grey closed-neck suit. Whether that makes him look more investor-friendly is debatable, but it seemed to work. As in the 2007 summit, Ratan Tata once again showered praise on Modi when he described how he was able to get all the approvals for the Nano project in just three days, adding: "A fast clearance would generally mean three to



“Gujarat has created the right atmosphere which is drawing investors to it like a magnet even in these bad times and in spite of a rival government at the Centre.”

SUNIL MITTAL, chairman, Bharti Enterprises